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### PLL circuit and transmission system

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#### Abstract

A phase-locked loop (PLL) circuit generates an output clock signal and includes: a selection circuit that selects one of a plurality of clock signals as a reference clock signal of the PLL circuit; and a control circuit that when a switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal, temporarily reduces a division ratio used by a frequency divider that generates a feedback clock signal to be compared with the reference clock signal.

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## Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This is a continuation application of PCT International Application No. PCT/JP2022/031746 filed on Aug. 23, 2022, designating the United States of America, which is based on and claims priority of Japanese Patent Application No. 2021-137169 filed on Aug. 25, 2021. The entire disclosures of the above-identified applications, including the specifications, drawings and claims are incorporated herein by reference in their entirety.

### FIELD

(1) The present invention relates to a PLL circuit and a transmission system that can switch a reference clock signal.

### BACKGROUND

(2) Patent Literature (PTL) 1 proposes a phase-locked loop (PLL) circuit, which can switch a reference clock signal, that generates no phase shift between a reference clock signal and a comparison clock signal when the reference clock signal is switched and obtains stable output also at the time of switching, which can be achieved with a simple configuration.

### CITATION LIST

Patent Literature

(3) PTL 1: Japanese Unexamined Patent Application Publication No. 2003-243980

### SUMMARY

#### Technical Problem

(4) According to PTL 1, however, there is a case where there is still a phase shift between a reference clock signal and a comparison clock signal when the reference clock signal is switched, and the problem is that frequency fluctuation may occur.

(5) In view of this, the present disclosure has an object to provide a PLL circuit and a transmission system that inhibit frequency fluctuation at the time of switching a reference clock signal.

#### Solution to Problem

(6) To achieve the above object, a PLL circuit according to one aspect of the present disclosure generates an output clock signal and includes: a selection circuit that selects one of a plurality of clock signals as a reference clock signal of the PLL circuit; and a control circuit that when a switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal, temporarily reduces a division ratio used by a frequency divider that generates a feedback clock signal to be compared with the reference clock signal.

(7) A transmission system according to one aspect of the present disclosure includes: the above-described PLL circuit; a converter that converts parallel data into serial data in synchronization with the output clock signal; and a transmission driver that outputs the serial data to a communication line.

(8) Note that these general or specific aspects may be achieved by a system, a method, an integrated circuit, or any combination thereof.

#### Advantageous Effects

(9) With the PLL circuit and transmission system according to the present disclosure, frequency fluctuation at the time of switching a reference clock signal can be inhibited.

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## Description

### BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) These and other advantages and features will become apparent from the following description thereof taken in conjunction with the accompanying Drawings, by way of non-limiting examples of embodiments disclosed herein.

(2) FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating an example of the configuration of a PLL circuit according to an embodiment.

(3) FIG. 2 is a circuit diagram illustrating an example of the configuration of the switching circuit in FIG. 1.

(4) FIG. 3 is a circuit diagram illustrating an example of the configuration of the frequency divider in FIG. 1.

(5) FIG. 4 is a circuit diagram illustrating an example of the configuration of the synchronization circuit in FIG. 3.

(6) FIG. 5 is a circuit diagram illustrating an example of the configuration of the phase comparator in FIG. 1.

(7) FIG. 6 is a time chart illustrating an example of an operation performed in the frequency divider in FIG. 3.

(8) FIG. 7 is a time chart illustrating an example of an operation performed in the PLL circuit according to the embodiment.

(9) FIG. 8 is a circuit diagram illustrating a variation of the phase comparator in FIG. 5.

(10) FIG. 9 is a circuit diagram illustrating another variation of the phase comparator in FIG. 5.

(11) FIG. 10 is a block diagram illustrating an example of the configuration of a transmission system according to the embodiment.

(12) FIG. 11 is a block diagram illustrating the configuration of a PLL circuit according to conventional techniques.

(13) FIG. 12 is a time chart illustrating an operation that may occur when using the conventional techniques.

(14) FIG. 13 is an illustration showing frequency fluctuation that may occur in a clock switching operation according to the conventional techniques.

(15) FIG. 14 is an illustration showing reduced frequency fluctuation in a clock switching operation.

#### DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENT

(16) (Underlying Knowledge Forming Basis of the Present Disclosure)

(17) The inventors have found that the following problems related to the PLL circuit according to the conventional techniques which is mentioned in the “Background Art” section occur. FIG. 11 is a diagram illustrating the configuration of the conventional PLL circuit. This PLL circuit corresponds to the circuit in FIG. 1 of PTL 1. FIG. 12 is a time chart showing an operation that may be generated by reference clock signal switching in FIG. 11.

(18) In FIG. 12, a clock switching signal is a signal that instructs switching of a reference clock signal. A reference clock signal is a signal to be output from the selector to the phase comparator. A comparison clock signal is a signal to be output from the frequency divider to the phase comparator. A reset signal is a signal to be output from the timing generator to the frequency divider.

(19) In a period in which the clock switching signal is at low-level in FIG. 12, clock A is selected as a reference clock signal and the reference clock signal is in a locked state. After the clock switching signal is changed from low-level to high-level, the reference clock signal is switched from clock A to clock B.

(20) The reset signal is asserted (a negative logic pulse is output) at the timing of the first edge (the rising edge in FIG. 12) of the reference clock signal after the reference clock signal is switched, and clears the counter of the frequency divider. The operation of the counter of the frequency divider stops only for the pulse width of the reset signal (the duration of L level). The phase difference between the reference clock signal and the comparison clock signal occurs only during a time corresponding to the pulse width.

(21) Even when the frequency of clock A is same as the frequency of clock B, the phase difference is transmitted to voltage-controlled oscillator VCXCO via a filter, and frequency fluctuation occurs.

(22) If the frequency divider is provided with a synchronization circuit that synchronizes a reset timing (i.e., the rising timing of a reset pulse) with an output clock signal, the reset timing is delayed and the phase difference further increases.

(23) As shown in the dotted circle in FIG. 12, when the stop period of the reference clock signal is long at the time of clock switching, a clock pulse unnecessary for the comparison clock signal may occur during the stop period. This unnecessary clock pulse may be a factor that causes a frequency to fluctuate greatly.

(24) FIG. 13 is an illustration showing frequency fluctuation that may be caused in a conventional clock switching operation. As illustrated in FIG. 13, frequency fluctuation  $\Delta F$  occurs at the time of reference clock signal switching. In one example of a general PLL circuit before the appearance of the PLL circuit according to PTL 1,  $\Delta F$  may increase to approximately 30000 ppm. Although it is conceivable that the PLL circuit according to PTL 1 can reduce frequency fluctuation  $\Delta F$  to less than 30000 ppm, the problems described above still remain to be overcome.

(25) In recent years, there has been a demand that frequency fluctuation  $\Delta f$  at the time of reference clock signal switching be further reduced ( $\Delta f \ll \Delta F$ ) as illustrated in FIG. 14. For example, the universal serial bus 4 (USB4) standard requires  $\Delta f = 1400$  ppm or less.

(26) In view of this, the present disclosure provides a PLL circuit and a transmission system that inhibit frequency fluctuation at the time of reference clock signal switching.

(27) To overcome the above problems, a PLL circuit according to one aspect of the present disclosure generates an output clock signal and includes: a selection circuit that selects one of a

plurality of clock signals as a reference clock signal of the PLL circuit; and a control circuit that when a switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal, temporarily reduces a division ratio used by a frequency divider that generates a feedback clock signal to be compared with the reference clock signal.

(28) A transmission system according to one aspect of the present disclosure includes the above-described PLL circuit; a converter that converts parallel data into serial data in synchronization with the output clock signal; and a transmission driver that outputs the serial data to a communication line.

(29) Note that these general or specific aspects may be achieved by a system, a method, an integrated circuit, a computer program, or any combination thereof.

(30) Hereinafter, an embodiment of a PLL circuit and a transmission system according to one aspect of the present disclosure will be described in detail with reference to the drawings.

(31) Note that the embodiment described below shows a general or specific example of the present disclosure. Numerical values, shapes, materials, elements, the arrangement and connection of the elements, steps, orders of steps, etc., indicated in the following embodiment are merely examples, and do not intend to limit the present disclosure. Among elements in the following embodiment, those not recited in any of the independent claims reciting the broadest concept are described as optional elements.

## EMBODIMENT

(32) [1.1 Configuration of PLL Circuit]

(33) First, the configuration of a PLL circuit according to an embodiment will be described.

(34) FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating an example of the configuration of PLL circuit 1 according to the embodiment. PLL circuit 1 in FIG. 1 includes voltage-controlled oscillator 2, frequency divider 3, phase comparator 40, low-pass filter 6, and switching circuit 7.

(35) Voltage-controlled oscillator (VCO) 2 oscillates at a frequency according to a control voltage from low-pass filter 6 to generate output clock signal VCLK.

(36) Frequency divider 3 divides the frequency of output clock signal VCLK and outputs the result of the frequency division as feedback clock signal FB to phase comparator 40. Frequency divider 3 is reset by reset signal NRST and is brought into a stopped state. Frequency divider 3 changes a division ratio to start frequency division while division ratio switching signal CHG is asserted. The division ratio is N when the frequency of output clock signal VCLK is multiplied by  $1/N$ . N may be a positive integer.

(37) Phase comparator 40 detects the phase difference between feedback clock signal FB output from frequency divider 3 and reference clock signal REF. For this reason, phase comparator 40 includes, for example, phase frequency detector (PFD) 4 and charge pump (CP) 5.

(38) PFD 4 detects the phase difference and frequency difference between reference clock signal REF and feedback clock signal FB. Hereinafter, a phase difference and a frequency difference are not specifically distinguished from each other and are each simply referred to as a phase difference.

(39) CP 5 outputs or inputs a current in accordance with the detected phase difference.

(40) Low-pass filter 6 outputs a control voltage in accordance with the detected phase difference to voltage-controlled oscillator 2. Specifically, low-pass filter 6 generates a control voltage by converting the current output or input from CP 5 into a smoothed voltage.

(41) Switching circuit 7 is a circuit that switches reference clock signal REF according to a clock switching signal. For this reason, switching signal 7 includes selection circuit 70 and control circuit 75.

(42) Selection circuit 70 selects one of clock signals according to a clock switching signal and outputs the selected clock signal to phase comparator 40 as reference clock signal REF. Two examples of the clock signals, first clock signal CLK1 and second clock signal CLK2, are illustrated in FIG. 1. First clock signal CLK1 and second clock signal CLK2 may be clock signals with the same frequency and different phases, and may be, for example, recovery clocks or any



clocks other than recovery clocks. A recovery clock is a clock signal that is reproduced in accordance with the timing at which received serial data is changed.

(43) Control circuit **75** performs control to temporarily reduce the division ratio used by frequency divider **3** at the time of switching for the selection of reference clock signal REF. Control circuit **75** also performs control of temporarily masking a detection result obtained by phase comparator **40** at the time of switching for the selection of reference clock signal REF.

(44) Temporarily reducing a division ratio in frequency divider **3** temporarily reduces the cycle of feedback clock signal FB. When the first edge timing of feedback clock signal FB from frequency divider **3** is little delayed relative to the first edge timing of reference clock signal REF immediately after switching, for example, it is possible to match the edge timing of reference clock signal REF in the next cycle with the edge timing of feedback clock signal FB in the next cycle. As a result, the frequency fluctuation of output clock signal VCLK which is caused by the switching of reference clock signal REF can be inhibited.

(45) At the time of switching for the selection of a reference clock signal, an extra clock pulse of one of the reference clock signal and the feedback clock signal may be output by mistake at the time of switching for the selection of a reference clock signal, but a phase difference due to this extra pulse can be masked in the masking control.

(46) [1.2 Configuration of Switching Circuit]

(47) Next, the detailed configuration of switching circuit **7** will be described.

(48) FIG. **2** is a circuit diagram illustrating an example of the configuration of switching circuit **7** in FIG. **1**. In FIG. **2**, switching circuit **7** includes selection circuit **70** and control circuit **75**.

(49) Selection circuit **70** includes logic circuit **71**, AND circuit **72**, AND circuit **73**, and OR circuit **74**. In FIG. **2**, a clock switching signal instructs one of first clock signal CLK1 and second clock signal CLK2 at low-level and instructs the other of first clock signal CLK1 and second clock signal CLK2 at high-level.

(50) In logic circuit **71**, a clock switching signal, first clock signal CLK1 and second clock signal CLK2 are input, and one of first clock selection signal 1SEL and second clock selection signal 2SEL is raised to high-level, i.e., made active. However, immediately after the clock switching signal is changed, i.e., immediately after the switching of reference clock signal REF is instructed, logic circuit **71** provides a non-selection period during which both of first clock selection signal 1SEL and second clock selection signal 2SEL are temporarily lowered to low-level. The non-selection period is provided to prevent glitch noise from OR circuit **74**, which is caused by the switching of reference clock signal REF, from being made or generated. As used herein, a glitch is a whisker-like pulse that has a short width and is not intended. When this pulse affects the circuit in the next step and the following steps, the pulse is referred to as “glitch noise”.

(51) AND circuit **72** outputs the logical conjunction of first clock signal CLK1 and first clock selection signal 1SEL. In other words, AND circuit **72** outputs first clock signal CLK1 when first clock selection signal 1SEL is at high-level, and does not output first clock signal CLK1 but outputs low-level when first clock selection signal 1SEL is at low-level.

(52) AND circuit **73** outputs the logical conjunction of second clock signal CLK2 and second clock selection signal 2SEL. In other words, AND circuit **73** outputs second clock signal CLK2 when second clock selection signal 2SEL is at high-level, and does not output second clock signal CLK2 but outputs low-level when second clock selection signal 2SEL is at low-level.

(53) OR circuit **74** outputs the logical disjunction of the output of AND circuit **72** and the output of switching circuit **7**. OR circuit **74** outputs one of first clock signal CLK1 and second clock signal CLK2 as reference clock signal REF. However, OR circuit **74** outputs neither first clock signal CLK1 nor second clock signal CLK2 and outputs low-level in the non-selection period.

(54) Control circuit **75** includes XOR circuit **76**, flip-flop **77**, flip-flop **78**, and inversion circuit **79**. With this, control circuit **75** generates various control signals for performing control of temporarily reducing a division ratio and control of temporarily masking a detection result obtained by phase

comparator **40**.

(55) XOR circuit **76** outputs the exclusive logical disjunction of first clock selection signal **1SEL** and second clock selection signal **2SEL**. The output of XOR circuit **76** is input to the reset terminals of flip-flop **77** and flip-flop **78**. As a result, XOR circuit **76** resets flip-flop **77** and flip-flop **78** when both of first clock selection signal **1SEL** and second clock selection signal **2SEL** are lowered to low-level. In other words, XOR circuit **76** brings flip-flop **77** and flip-flop **78** into a reset state in the non-selection period, and cancels the reset state when one of first clock selection signal **1SEL** and second clock selection signal **2SEL** is raised to high-level. An OR circuit may be used instead of XOR circuit **76**.

(56) High-level is always input to the D input terminal of flip-flop **77**. Reference clock signal REF is input to the clock input terminal of flip-flop **77**. The output signal of XOR circuit **76** is input to the reset input terminal of flip-flop **77**. As a result, in flip-flop **77**, the Q output terminal is changed from high-level to low-level at the start timing of the non-selection period and is then changed to high-level at the first rising edge of reference clock signal REF after the non-selection period is ended. The signal of the Q output terminal is output as reset signal NRST to frequency divider **3**.

(57) The Q output terminal of flip-flop **77** is connected to the D input terminal of flip-flop **78** and reset signal NRST is input to the D input terminal of flip-flop **78**. Reference clock signal REF is input to the inversion clock input terminal of flip-flop **78**. The output signal of XOR circuit **76** is input to the reset input terminal of flip-flop **78**. As a result, the Q output terminal of flip-flop **78** is changed from high-level to low-level at the start timing of the non-selection period, and flip-flop **78** takes in reset signal NRST from the D input terminal and outputs reset signal NRST from the Q output terminal at the first falling edge of reference clock signal REF after the non-selection period is ended. The signal of the Q output terminal is output as mask signal NMSK to phase comparator **40**.

(58) Inversion circuit **79** inverts mask signal NMSK and outputs the inverted signal as division ratio switching signal CHG to frequency divider **3**.

(59) Operations using various signals in FIG. 2 will be described later with reference to FIG. 7.

(60) [1.3 Configuration of Frequency Divider]

(61) Next, the detailed configuration of frequency divider **3** will be described.

(62) FIG. 3 is a circuit diagram illustrating an example of the configuration of frequency divider **3** in FIG. 1. FIG. 4 is a circuit diagram illustrating an example of the configuration of synchronization circuit **30** in FIG. 3.

(63) As illustrated in FIG. 3, frequency divider **3** includes synchronization circuit **30** and counter-type frequency divider circuit **31**. Counter-type frequency divider circuit **31** includes counter **32** and comparator **33**.

(64) Synchronization circuit **30** is a circuit that causes reset signal NRST to synchronize with output clock signal VCLK. For this reason, synchronization circuit **30** includes, in the configuration example in FIG. 4, inversion circuit **34**, flip-flop **35**, and flip-flop **36**.

(65) Inversion circuit **34** inverts output clock signal VCLK and outputs the inverted signal to the clock input terminals of flip-flop **35** and flip-flop **36**.

(66) Flip-flop **35** takes in and retains reset signal NRST at the rising edge of the inverted signal from inversion circuit **34** (i.e., at the falling edge of output clock signal VCLK), and outputs the retained signal from the Q output terminal.

(67) Flip-flop **36** takes in and retains the signal from the Q output terminal of flip-flop **35** at the rising edge of the inverted signal from inversion circuit **34** (i.e., at the falling edge of output clock signal VCLK), and outputs the retained signal from the Q output terminal. The signal output from the Q output terminal of flip-flop **36** is output as counter reset signal NRES to counter **32**. Counter reset signal NRES is a signal that delayed reset signal NRST for two clock periods of output clock signal VCLK. Stated differently, counter reset signal NRES is a signal that caused reset signal NRST to synchronize with output clock signal VCLK.

(68) Counter-type frequency divider circuit **31** divides the frequency of output clock signal VCLK at division ratio N and outputs feedback clock signal FB. Counter-type frequency divider circuit **31** in the example in FIG. 3 includes counter **32** and comparator **33**.

(69) Counter **32** counts the number of clock pulses of output clock signal VCLK.

(70) Comparator **33** compares the count value of counter **32** and division ratio N, and initializes counter **32** when the count value matches division ratio N. Comparator **33** determines whether division ratio (N-m) instructed by division ratio setting signal mSET matches the count value when division ratio switching signal CHG is being asserted. m is an integer corresponding to the time difference between the edge timing of reference clock signal REF immediately after switching and the start timing of frequency divider **3** immediately after reset cancel. In the configuration example in FIG. 3, m denotes the time difference between the rising edge of reset signal NRST and the rising edge of counter reset signal NRES, and corresponds to two clocks of output clock signal VCLK (m=2). Thus, frequency divider **3** performs frequency division at division ratio (N-m) when division ratio switching signal CHG is being asserted.

(71) [1.4 Configuration of Phase Comparator]

(72) Next, the more detailed configuration of phase comparator **40** will be described.

(73) FIG. 5 is a circuit diagram illustrating an example of the configuration of phase comparator **40** in FIG. 1. Phase comparator **40** in FIG. 5 includes PFD **4** and CP **5**.

(74) PFD **4** includes flip-flop **41**, flip-flop **42**, and NAND circuit **43**.

(75) Flip-flop **41** outputs low-level from the Q output terminal in a reset state or immediately after reset cancel. In a state other than a reset state, flip-flop **41** takes in and retains the high-level of the D input terminal at the timing of the rising edge of reference clock signal REF, and also outputs high-level as an UP signal from the Q output terminal.

(76) Flip-flop **42** outputs low-level from the Q output terminal in a reset state or immediately after reset cancel. Flip-flop **42** takes in and retains the high-level of the D input terminal at the timing of the rising edge of feedback clock signal FB, and also outputs high-level as a DOWN signal from the Q output terminal.

(77) NAND circuit **43** outputs an output signal obtained by inverting the logical conjunction of the UP signal, the DOWN signal, and mask signal NMSK to the reset input terminal of flip-flop **41** and the reset input terminal of flip-flop **42**. When mask signal NMSK is at high-level (i.e., mask signal NBSK is not masked), NAND circuit **43** neither resets flip-flop **41** nor flip-flop **42** when neither the UP signal nor the DOWN signal is at high-level, and resets flip-flop **41** and flip-flop **42** when both of the UP signal and the DOWN signal are at high-level. As a result, when the rising edge of reference clock signal REF is earlier than the rising edge of feedback clock signal FB, a pulse width corresponding to the phase difference between the two signals appears in the UP signal, and a pulse whose duration is short enough to be ignored appears in the DOWN signal. In contrast, when the rising edge of reference clock signal REF is later than the rising edge of feedback clock signal FB, a pulse whose duration is short enough to be ignored appears in the UP signal and a pulse width corresponding to the phase difference between the two signals appears in the DOWN signal. When mask signal NMSK is at low-level, flip-flop **41** and flip-flop **42** are in a reset state. Accordingly, when mask signal NMSK is at low-level, both the UP signal and the DOWN signal are masked.

(78) CP **5** includes current source **51**, switch **52**, switch **53**, and current source **54**.

(79) Current source **51** and switch **52** provide low-pass filter **6** with current ICP in accordance with the pulse width of an UP signal. In this case, current ICP flows from CP **5** to low-pass filter **6**. As a result, the UP signal works to increase the frequency of output clock signal VCLK via low-pass filter **6** and voltage-controlled oscillator **2**.

(80) Switch **53** and current source **54** take out, from low-pass filter **6**, current ICP in accordance with the pulse width of a DOWN signal. In this case, current ICP flows from low-pass filter **6** to CP **5**. As a result, the DOWN signal works to decrease the frequency of output clock signal VCLK via

low-pass filter 6 and voltage-controlled oscillator 2.

(81) [2. Operation]

(82) The following describes an operation of PLL circuit 1 according to the embodiment which is configured as described above.

(83) First, an example of an operation performed in frequency divider 3 will be described.

(84) FIG. 6 is a time chart illustrating an example of an operation performed in frequency divider 3 in FIG. 3. FIG. 3 illustrates the switching timings of division ratio switching signal CHG, feedback clock signal FB, and a division ratio. It is assumed that the rising edge of feedback clock signal FB occurs at a count start timing to start counting in the frequency division operation.

(85) As indicated at time  $t_0$  and time  $t_3$ , the frequency division operation is started at division ratio N when division ratio switching signal CHG is at low-level at the count start timing.

(86) As indicated at time  $t_1$  and  $t_2$ , the frequency division operation is started at division ratio (N-m) when division ratio switching signal CHG is at high-level at the count start timing. m is specified by frequency division setting signal mSET.

(87) Frequency divider 3 thus switches the division ratio in accordance with the level of division ratio switching signal CHG at the count start timing.

(88) When frequency divider 3 is reset in the period from time  $t_0$  to time  $t_1$ , the frequency division operation is stopped in the period from time  $t_0$  to time  $t_1$  and the pulse of feedback clock signal FB is not to be output.

(89) Next, an example of an operation performed in PLL circuit 1 will be described.

(90) FIG. 7 is a time chart illustrating an example of an operation performed in a PLL circuit according to the embodiment.

(91) In the period from time  $t_1$  to time  $t_5$ , first clock signal CLK1 is selected and output as reference clock signal REF in selection circuit 70. In this period, reference clock signal REF and feedback clock signal FB are in a locked state in which the phase of reference clock signal REF matches the phase of feedback clock signal FB, and the UP signal and the DOWN signal each have a pulse width that is short enough to be ignored.

(92) At time  $t_4$ , the clock switching signal changes from low-level to high-level. In other words, the clock switching signal instructs that reference clock signal REF is to be switched from first clock signal CLK1 to second clock signal CLK2.

(93) With the change in the clock switching signal, selection circuit 70 sets the period from time  $t_5$  to time  $t_7$  as a non-selection period and lowers both first clock selection signal 1SEL and second clock selection signal 2SEL to low-level.

(94) With both first clock selection signal 1SEL and second clock selection signal 2SEL having been changed to low-level at time  $t_5$ , the output of reference clock signal REF is stopped. Control circuit 75 changes mask signal NMSK, reset signal NRST, and division ratio switching signal CHG to be active.

(95) In the period from time  $t_5$  to time  $t_7$ , i.e., the non-selection period, reference clock signal REF is not output. At time  $t_7$  when second clock selection signal 2SEL is asserted and thereafter, second clock signal CLK2 is selected and output as reference clock signal REF.

(96) In the period from time  $t_5$  to time  $t_{10}$ , mask signal NMSK becomes active. During this period, the UP signal and the DOWN signal are both masked in phase comparator 40 and neither the UP signal nor the DOWN signal is output. As a result, the UP signal indicating the phase difference from time  $t_8$  to time  $t_9$  is masked. The DOWN signal in the very short period between time  $t_8$  and time  $t_9$  is also masked.

(97) In the period from time  $t_5$  to time  $t_8$ , reset signal NRST becomes active. With this, frequency divider 3 stops the frequency division operation.

(98) In the period from time  $t_5$  to time  $t_{10}$ , division ratio switching signal CHG becomes active. The division ratio of a frequency division operation that is performed by frequency divider 3 and starts in this period is changed. In FIG. 7, the division ratio is changed from N to (N-m).

(99) In the period from time **t6** to time **t9**, counter reset signal **NRES** becomes active. At time **t9**, counter reset signal **NRES** becomes inactive and a frequency division operation at division ratio  $(N-m)$  starts.

(100) At time **t9**, the frequency division operation at ratio  $(N-m)$  performed by frequency divider **3** starts and the rising edge of feedback clock signal **FB** occurs. Here,  $m=2$  and  $m$  denotes the time difference between the rising edge of reset signal **NRST** and the rising edge of counter reset signal **NRES**. Accordingly, at time **t11** when the first cycle of the frequency division operation at division ratio  $(N-m)$  is completed, the phase difference between reference clock signal **REF** and feedback clock signal **FB** gets closer to 0. At this point in time, PLL circuit **1** is in a locked state and frequency fluctuation is inhibited to a large extent.

(101) At time **t11**, since division ratio switching signal **CHG** is not active, a frequency division operation at division ratio **N** starts.

(102) At time **t12**, one cycle of the frequency division operation at division ratio **N** is completed and the phase difference between reference clock signal **REF** and feedback clock signal **FB** becomes 0. At this point in time, the locked state of PLL circuit **1** is maintained and frequency fluctuation is inhibited to a large extent.

(103) Thus, in the operation example in FIG. 7, frequency fluctuation at the time of clock switching can be inhibited, as illustrated in FIG. 14.

(104) The example that applies  $m=2$  is illustrated in FIG. 7, but  $m=1$  may be applied. In the case of  $m=1$ , the phase difference corresponding to one cycle of output clock signal **VCLK** remains at time **t11** and the phase difference becomes 0 at time **t12** in FIG. 7. Even in this case, since PLL circuit **1** is in a locked state at time **t12**, frequency fluctuation can be sufficiently inhibited. In this way,  $m$  may correspond to the time difference between the rising edge of reset signal **NRST** and the rising edge of counter reset signal **NRES**, or correspond to the duration of a time less than the time difference.

(105) Phase comparator **40** may be added in the configuration in FIG. 8 or FIG. 9, instead of FIG. 5. In FIG. 5, mask signal **NMSK** indirectly masks the UP signal, the DOWN signal, and current **ICP** by resetting flip-flop **41** and flip-flop **42**. In FIG. 8, mask signal **NMSK** directly masks the UP signal and the DOWN signal. In FIG. 9, mask signal **NMSK** directly masks current **ICP**.

(106) [3. Transmission System]

(107) Next, a transmission system according to the embodiment will be described.

(108) FIG. 10 is a block diagram illustrating an example of the configuration of the transmission system according to the embodiment. The transmission system in FIG. 10 includes PLL circuit **1**, parallel-serial converter **11**, and transmission driver **12**.

(109) PLL circuit **1** may be configured as in FIG. 1. For example, one of first clock signal **CLK1** and second clock signal **CLK2** is a recovery clock and the other of first clock signal **CLK1** and second clock signal **CLK2** is a clock other than a recovery clock.

(110) Parallel-serial converter **11** is a shift register that loads and outputs parallel data as serial data in synchronization with output clock signal **VCLK** from PLL circuit **1**.

(111) Transmission driver **12** outputs the serial data output from parallel-serial converter **11** to a communication line.

(112) As described above, the PLL circuit according to the embodiment generates an output clock signal and includes: a selection circuit that selects one of a plurality of clock signals as a reference clock signal of the PLL circuit; and a control circuit that when a switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal, temporarily reduces a division ratio used by a frequency divider that generates a feedback clock signal to be compared with the reference clock signal.

(113) With the PLL circuit described above, frequency fluctuation of an output clock signal, which is caused by the switching of a reference clock signal, can be inhibited. Temporarily reducing a division ratio temporarily reduces the cycle of a feedback clock signal. For example, when the first edge timing of the feedback clock signal from the frequency divider is little delayed relative to the

first edge timing of the reference clock signal immediately after switching, it is possible to match the edge timing of the reference clock signal in the next cycle with the edge timing of the feedback clock signal in the next cycle.

(114) When the switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal, the control circuit may temporarily mask a detection result obtained by a phase comparator in the PLL circuit.

(115) With the above feature, when one of pulses of a reference clock signal and a feedback clock signal is output unnecessarily by mistake, a phase difference due to that unnecessary pulse can be masked. When glitch noise occurs in the reference clock signal at the time of switching for the selection of the reference clock signal, a phase difference due to the glitch noise can be masked. This can inhibit frequency fluctuation at the time of switching for the selection of the reference clock signal.

(116) A PLL circuit according to the embodiment includes: an oscillator that generates an output clock signal; a frequency divider that divides the frequency of the output clock signal; a phase comparator that detects the phase difference between a reference clock signal and a feedback clock signal output from the frequency divider; a filter circuit that outputs, to the oscillator, a control signal in accordance with the detected phase difference; a selection circuit that selects and outputs, as the reference clock signal, one of a plurality of clock signals to the phase comparator; and a control circuit that when a switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal, temporarily reduces a division ratio used by the frequency divider.

(117) With the PLL circuit described above, frequency fluctuation of an output clock signal caused by the switching of a reference clock signal can be inhibited. Temporarily reducing a division ratio temporarily reduces the cycle of a feedback clock signal. For example, when the first edge timing of the feedback clock signal from the frequency divider is little delayed relative to the first edge timing of the reference clock signal immediately after switching, it is possible to match the edge timing of the reference clock signal in the next cycle with the edge timing of the feedback clock signal in the next cycle.

(118) The control circuit may reset the frequency divider when the switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal. A period in which the division ratio is temporarily reduced may be a single cycle or a plurality of cycles of the feedback clock signal immediately after reset cancel of the frequency divider.

(119) With this feature, when the first edge timing of a feedback clock signal from the frequency divider is little delayed relative to the first edge timing of a reference clock signal immediately after switching, for example, an edge timing in the next cycle (or a cycle after few cycles) immediately after reset cancel can be matched between the reference clock signal and the feedback clock signal.

(120) The control circuit may temporarily change the division ratio from  $N$  to  $(N-m)$  when the switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal, where  $N$  may be an integer indicating a division ratio in a locked state before the reference clock signal is switched, and  $m$  may be an integer corresponding to the time difference between the edge timing of the reference clock signal immediately after the reference clock signal is switched and the start timing of the frequency divider immediately after reset cancel.

(121) With this feature, edge timing of the feedback clock signal in the next cycle immediately after reset cancel can be matched with the first edge timing of the reference clock signal immediately after switching. As a result, frequency fluctuation can be inhibited to a large extent.

(122) The control circuit may output a division ratio switching signal to the frequency divider, and the frequency divider may start dividing a frequency at a small division ratio in a period in which the division ratio switching signal is being asserted.

(123) With this feature, the control of temporarily reducing a division ratio can be readily performed.

(124) When the switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal, the control circuit may temporarily mask a signal indicating the phase difference generated by the phase comparator.

(125) With this feature, when one of pulses of a reference clock signal and a feedback clock signal is unnecessarily output by mistake at the time of switching for the selection of a reference clock signal, a phase difference due to that unnecessary pulse can be masked. When glitch noise occurs in a reference clock signal at the time of switching for the selection of the reference clock signal, a phase difference due to the glitch noise can be masked. This can inhibit frequency fluctuation at the time of switching for the selection of the reference clock signal.

(126) The control circuit may cancel the masking when the phase difference between the reference clock signal and the feedback clock signal is less than a threshold.

(127) With this feature, a period in which masking is effective can be optimized.

(128) The selection circuit may have a stop period during which the selection circuit stops the output of the reference clock signal when the switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal. The control circuit may bring the frequency divider into a reset state in the stop period and cancel the reset state of the frequency divider at the edge timing of the reference clock signal, where the edge timing occurs when the stop period is ended.

(129) With this feature, unnecessary output of a reference clock signal can be prevented at the time of switching for the selection of the reference clock signal owing to a stop period and reset cancel, which in turn makes it possible to reduce the factors of frequency fluctuation.

(130) The selection circuit may not output glitch noise when the switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal.

(131) With this feature, glitch noise that causes frequency fluctuation can be reduced at the time of switching for the selection of the reference clock signal.

(132) A transmission system according to the embodiment includes: the above-described PLL circuit; a converter that converts parallel data into serial data in synchronization with the output clock signal; and a transmission driver that outputs the serial data to a communication line.

(133) In the above-described embodiment, each of elements may be implemented by dedicated hardware or by executing a software program suitable for the element. Each of the elements may be implemented by a program executor such as a CPU or a processor reading and executing a software program recorded on, for instance, a semiconductor memory.

(134) Although the PLL circuit and transmission system according to one or more aspects of the present disclosure have been described based on an embodiment, the present disclosure is not limited to the embodiment. Other embodiments obtained by various modifications of the embodiments that may be conceived by persons skilled in the art, as well as embodiments resulting from arbitrary combinations of elements from different embodiments that do not depart from the essence of the present disclosure are also included in one or more aspects of the present disclosure.

## INDUSTRIAL APPLICABILITY

(135) The present disclosure is applicable to a PLL circuit that can switch a reference clock signal.

## Claims

1. A phase-locked loop (PLL) circuit that generates an output clock signal, the PLL circuit comprising: a selection circuit that selects one of a plurality of clock signals as a reference clock signal of the PLL circuit; and a control circuit that when a switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal, temporarily reduces a division ratio used by a frequency divider that generates a feedback clock signal to be compared with the reference clock signal, wherein the control circuit resets the frequency divider when the switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal, and a period in which the division ratio is temporarily reduced is a single cycle or a plurality of cycles of the feedback clock signal immediately after reset cancel of the frequency divider.

2. The PLL circuit according to claim 1, wherein when the switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal, the control circuit temporarily masks a detection result obtained by a phase

comparator in the PLL circuit.

3. The PLL circuit according to claim 2, wherein the control circuit cancels the masking when a phase difference between the reference clock signal and the feedback clock signal is less than a threshold.

4. The PLL circuit according to claim 1, further comprising: an oscillator that generates the output clock signal; a phase comparator that detects a phase difference between the reference clock signal and a feedback clock signal output from the frequency divider; and a filter circuit that outputs, to the oscillator, a control signal in accordance with the phase difference detected.

5. The PLL circuit according to claim 4, wherein when the switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal, the control circuit temporarily masks a signal indicating the phase difference generated by the phase comparator.

6. A phase-locked loop (PLL) circuit that generates an output clock signal, the PLL circuit comprising: a selection circuit that selects one of a plurality of clock signals as a reference clock signal of the PLL circuit; and a control circuit that when a switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal, temporarily reduces a division ratio used by a frequency divider that generates a feedback clock signal to be compared with the reference clock signal, wherein the control circuit temporarily changes the division ratio from  $N$  to  $(N-m)$  when the switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal, where  $N$  is an integer indicating a division ratio in a locked state before the reference clock signal is switched, and  $m$  is an integer corresponding to a time difference between an edge timing of the reference clock signal immediately after the reference clock signal is switched and a start timing of the frequency divider immediately after reset cancel.

7. The PLL circuit according to claim 1, wherein the control circuit outputs a division ratio switching signal to the frequency divider, and the frequency divider starts dividing a frequency at a small division ratio in a period in which the division ratio switching signal is being asserted.

8. A phase-locked loop (PLL) circuit that generates an output clock signal, the PLL circuit comprising: a selection circuit that selects one of a plurality of clock signals as a reference clock signal of the PLL circuit; and a control circuit that when a switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal, temporarily reduces a division ratio used by a frequency divider that generates a feedback clock signal to be compared with the reference clock signal, wherein the selection circuit has a stop period during which the selection circuit does not output the reference clock signal when the switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal, and the control circuit brings the frequency divider into a reset state in the stop period and cancels the reset state of the frequency divider at an edge timing of the reference clock signal, the edge timing occurring when the stop period is ended.

9. The PLL circuit according to claim 1, wherein the selection circuit does not output glitch noise when the switch is made for the selection of the reference clock signal.

10. A transmission system comprising: the PLL circuit according to claim 1; a converter that converts parallel data into serial data in synchronization with the output clock signal; and a transmission driver that outputs the serial data to a communication line.

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